Policy and Procedure

Policy # HR12
Date Issued: October 2006
Effective Date: June 2006

Subject: TECHNOLOGY USAGE

Application: All employees, consultants, contractors, and temporaries and vendors

Policy Statement: The company is committed to providing an environment that encourages the use of computers and electronic information as essential tools to support its business. It is the responsibility of each employee to ensure that this technology is used for proper business purposes and in a manner that does not compromise the confidentiality of proprietary or other sensitive information. All Library computers systems, voicemail systems, electronic mail systems, Internet access systems and Networks are the property of the Company. Employees have no legitimate expectation of privacy in regard to system usage.

Overview:
This policy is an overview of acceptable use of electronic communication and equipment and is not intended to impose restrictions that are contrary to Brooklyn Public Library's established culture of openness, trust and integrity. This outlines procedures that relate to Internet/Intranet-related systems, including but not limited to computer equipment, software, operating systems, storage media, network accounts, voice mail and electronic mail, which are the property of the Company. These systems are intended to be used for business purposes in serving the interests of the company, and of our library users and customers in the course of normal operations.

Effective security is a team effort involving the participation and support of every Brooklyn Public Library employee and affiliate who deals with information and/or information systems. It is the responsibility of every computer user to know these guidelines, and to conduct their activities accordingly.

Purpose:
The Company is committed to protecting Brooklyn Public Library's employees, customers, partners, and itself from illegal or damaging actions, either knowingly or unknowingly committed. These rules are in place to protect the employee and the Company. Inappropriate use exposes the Company to risks including virus attacks, compromise of network systems and services, and legal issues.

Scope:
This policy applies to employees, contractors, consultants, temporaries, and other workers at the Company, including all personnel affiliated with third parties. This policy applies to all equipment that is owned or leased by the Company.

General Use and Ownership:

1. While the Company's network administration desires to provide a reasonable level of privacy, users should be aware that the data they create on the corporate systems remains the property of the Company.
   a. Because of the need to protect the Company's network, management cannot guarantee the privacy and confidentiality of information stored on any network device belonging to the Company including email and voicemail.
   b. Sensitive information should be sent by other methods.

2. While some slight personalization of a computer is allowed (example: a Screen Saver) the company computers and systems are property of the company and are not to be used in any way that does not comply with the Policy.

3. For security and network maintenance purposes, authorized individuals within the Company may monitor in the ordinary course of business equipment, systems and network traffic at any time, per Management Audit Policy to ensure compliance.

4. Employees, contractors, consultants, temporaries, and other workers at the Company shall report immediately to their Manager, or Supervisor any illegal activity, or action by another employee, contractor, consultant, temporary employee, or patron that may compromise a computer system, or the Network.

5. Under no circumstances is an employee of the Company authorized to engage in any activity that is illegal under local, state, federal, or international law while utilizing the Company owned equipment.

6. Any violations of the rights of any person or company protected by copyright, trade secret, patent or other intellectual property, or similar laws or regulations, including, but not limited to, the installation or distribution of “pirated” or other software for which there is not an active license, are prohibited by this policy.

7. Any unauthorized copying of copyrighted material including, but not limited to, digitization and distribution of photographs from magazines, books or other copyrighted materials, music, and video, in addition to the installation of copyrighted software for which there is no active license, is prohibited by this policy.

8. When using the Company's computers, voicemail, and/or internet connection, employees may not actively engage in procuring or transmitting material that is in violation of the Equal Employment Opportunity, Anti-Harassment and/or Workplace Violence policies.

Confidentiality & Security:

1. Employees should take all necessary steps to prevent unauthorized access to confidential information on all Library network systems. Passwords must be kept secure. Passwords must contain letters, numbers, and other characters to make them secure. Employees should not share each others' usernames, passwords, or account access. Authorized users are responsible for the security of their passwords and accounts.
2. Because information contained on portable computers is especially vulnerable, special care should be exercised. Laptops should be protected in accordance with the "Laptop Security Guidelines."
3. Postings by employees from a company email address to newsgroups should contain a disclaimer stating that the opinions expressed are strictly their own and not necessarily those of the Library, unless such posting is in the course of business duties.
4. Employees must use extreme caution when opening e-mail attachments received from unknown senders, which may contain viruses or other security-breaching mechanisms.

Email Procedures:

1. To enhance communication, the Library encourages staff to use their computer accounts and library computers in ways that advance the Library's interests and the staff member's job performance and professional standing.
2. Employee email is not considered to be private despite any such designation either by the sender or the recipient.
3. Email messages sent to recipients outside of the Library, if sent over the Internet and not encrypted, are not secure.
4. As noted above, the Library reserves the right, at its discretion to review any employee electronic file to the extent necessary to ensure electronic media and services are being used in compliance with the law and Library policy and procedures.

Voicemail Procedures:

1. Employee voicemail communications are not considered to be private despite any such designation either by the sender or the recipient.
2. The Company reserves the right, at its discretion to review any employee messages to the extent necessary to ensure electronic media and services are being used in compliance with the law and the company policies and procedures.

Internet Procedures:

1. The Company's connection to the Internet is provided primarily for the use of our patrons and for staff for business-related purposes. While the Company does not prohibit the use of our Internet connection by staff for personal use, such use may not interfere with staff members' work duties, may not interfere with optimal use of the network by all users, and may not be used in any way prohibited by this policy or any other Library policy. Examples of unauthorized use includes but it not limited to connecting, posting, or downloading pornographic material; engaging in computer-"hacking" and other related activities; attempting to disable or compromise the security of information contained on the Library's computers.
2. Because postings placed on the Internet may display the Company's address, make certain before posting information on the Internet that the information reflects the standards of the Company.

3. Unless explicitly written prior approval of Office of Technology has been obtained, staff may not establish Internet or other external network connections that could allow unauthorized persons to gain access to Company systems and information.

Library Equipment:

Computers:

1. Office of Technology will setup and configure all Computers based on a standard configuration, to meet the Company's business needs.

2. All computers will be configured with a standard set of applications, to provide staff with the essential set of tools for proper business purposes and use.

3. Any additional applications/software must be cleared first by the Office of Technology and must be installed by the Office of Technology and/or outside vendors in conjunction with Office of Technology, based upon departmental/ individual need.

4. Requests by a staff member for new/additional software must come from that individual's manager.

Laptop Computers:

1. Laptop computers which are assigned to specific staff members, will also be configured in the same manner as other computers and fall under the same policy.

Computers Accessories:

1. Purchases of all computer peripherals (storage devices, display devices, input devices, etc.) must be first approved by the Office of Technology to ensure compatibility and maintainability.

2. Computer peripherals are to be purchased based upon the business needs of the Company to further enhance the tools to allow staff members to perform their duties.

System and Network Activities:

The following activities are prohibited. The list below is by no means exhaustive, but attempts to provide a framework for activities which fall into the category of unacceptable use.

1. Attachment of any non Company owned/leased device to a Company Computer, or to the Company's network including but not limited to: personnel computer equipment, PDA's, laptops etc., without the express permission from the Office of Technology.

2. Configuration, reconfiguration, or alteration of any network device including but not limited to: hubs, modems, printers, switches, routers, etc.

3. Installation and use of any software including but not limited to: instant messaging software, file-sharing software, peer-to-peer software, monitoring software, etc.

4. Making fraudulent offers of products, items, or services originating from any Company account.

5. Effecting security breaches or disruptions of network communication. Security breaches include, but are not limited to, accessing data of which the employee is not an intended recipient.

6. Executing any form of network monitoring which will intercept data not intended for the employee or circumventing user authentication or security, unless this activity is a part of the employee's normal job/duty.

Enforcement:
Any employee found to have violated this policy will be subject to disciplinary action, including immediate termination of employment and based upon severity of violation possible criminal charges.

If there is any uncertainty regarding the technology usage policy, employees should consult their supervisor or manager.

Issuing Agency: Human Resources
Revision Date: June 2006
Related Public Documents:
Supersedes Policy: Electronic Communications
Related Policy: